

Section B: Areas, perspectives and debates

In this section, learners will be asked questions that invite them to generate an extended discussion, recognising the inter-relationship between different areas, perspectives and debates in psychology. They will not be limited in terms of the studies they can refer to in their answers. The specification places core studies within particular areas, but learners may make reference to studies from across the components and may also argue that a core study placed within one area can be seen as falling within another area.

Studies that come from a behaviourist perspective include Bandura's research into transmission of aggression and Watt's Funhler study, while psychodynamic ideas are referred to in the research by Freud (Little Hans), Kohlberg (stages of moral development) and Hancock (language of psychopaths); however, learners may refer to other studies.

Areas, perspectives and debates	Content
Areas • Social • Cognitive • Developmental • Biological • Individual Differences	• The defining principles and concepts of each area. • Research to illustrate each area. • Strengths and weaknesses of each area. • Applications of each area. • How each area is different from and similar to other areas.
Perspectives • Behaviourist • Psychodynamic	• The defining principles and concepts of each perspective. • Research to illustrate each perspective. • Strengths and weaknesses of each perspective. • Applications of each perspective. • How each perspective is different from and similar to the other perspective.
Debates • Nature/nurture • Freewill/determinism • Reductionism/holism • Individual/situational explanations • Usefulness of research • Ethical considerations • Conducting socially sensitive research • Psychology as a science	• The defining principles and concepts of each debate. • Different positions within each debate. • Research to illustrate different positions within each debate. • Applications of different positions within each debate. • How each debate is different from and similar to other debates.